# STATE SCAN

TAMIL NADU: FLAME OF CONFLICT PG 30

KERALA: A FRAUGHT ACQUITTAL PG 32




PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

**RUNNING ON EMPTY** Most units lie vacant in Kota colonies such as these, which exclusively house outstation students of coaching centres

RAJASTHAN

# LESSON FOR THE COACH

**A legal scrutiny may help weed out its distortions, but could also finish Kota's Rs 10,000 crore coaching industry**

*By* **Rohit Parihar**

**KOTA, SOME SAY, HAS** already had its quota of sunshine. Those inside of India's premier coaching destination feel it's getting more than its fair share of darkness. They see a hunting party on their trail: legislative, judiciary, executive, all in a posse. Why the purge? Well, certain distortions had crept in while the boom was on. Now it's pay time. Just that they fear the pile-up of negative news may end up mortally wounding a Rs 10,000 crore industry they had built up over three decades.

In November, a Lok Sabha standing committee was mandated to evaluate the coaching industry and regulations around it. That came close on the heels of a September order by the Rajasthan High Court, ordering a state-level SIT probe into 'dummy schools'—grey entities that tick fake attendance for Class 10 and 12 students who spend their days at coaching hubs but appear as regular school-goers on CBSE rolls.

In June, the Centre too had appointed a nine-member committee to examine the wider coaching ecosystem. Together, these interventions mark the most aggressive official scrutiny of the Kota model since it emerged in the